



of technical expertise and information on Linux Apache MySQL Perl/Python/PHP (LAMP) technologies under a single umbrella. It will complement the numerous well-entrenched Linux User Groups (LUGs) in India to

consolidate the Open Source knowledge base.

The site stresses on learning from the tutorials, and sharing on the forum. Links to any Open Source project can be uploaded, along with a short description, to the 'links' section.

ZDNet India Open Source is also organising what it calls the 'biggest contest on open Source Java' for Open Source developers. IBM will sponsor the prizes for the contest.

MEGAPIXEL PUZZLE

Pixel Puzzle

You are in the market to buy a digital camera that you have been saving

for, but are overwhelmed by the pixel figures—3.2, 4.1, and 5.1. The question: does a higher pixel number, mean a better picture? Apparently not! According to *Time* magazine, there is a lot more to digital cameras than just megapixels. According to Shyam Sunder, Manager, Digicam Products, Canon India, "A good digital camera consists of a lens, resolution and a processor; a compromise on either of these affects the picture taken." So, why do companies highlight the pixel factor?

Kartik Mehta of J J Mehta and Sons, one of India's largest dealers of digital cameras, says, "It is a combination of pixel, lens and processor and hence the price variation." Often digital cameras, advertised as being very cost effective, come with a digital zoom that does not translate to good pictures. Plus, beware of the difference between actual and effective pixels.

"During mass production, in one mass square area, a number of pixels are dead, which means they will never reflect any light. So, look out for effective pixels in cameras," warns Rajeev Jaswal, National Sales Manager, Olympus India.

How will you know then which is the right camera for you? As Sunder of Canon India says, "Do not get megapixel-hungry. A 3.2 megapixel for a home user would do just fine." While Mehta advises to opt for branded products, Jaswal points out that features such as a lithium battery and optical zoom are equally important. So, do look beyond the megapixel.

MENTAL MUSCLES

Codeprix '05

Want to test your brawn in writing sheer code?

Codeprix '05 can give you the arena to pit your skills



Trust Busters

Connect in haste and Repent at leisure seems to be the motto of Tata Indicom service. If newspaper reports are anything to go by, quite a few subscribers have been chanting complaints about its incorrect bills and inept service. Ankush Tambe from



Mumbai is one such example. The Indian Express recently reported that Tambe (Customer No: 500105566) was billed twice for the month of May. He received two bills from Tata Indicom, one on June 4, and the other on June 23. These twin bills matched right down to the challan number as well. Kirit Gore, another Indicom subscriber, went through all the gruelling procedures needed to cut the line. But all the hassles, it didn't get disconnected. A month later, his was still alive and ringing! As for Tata's response, Debashish Sur, Head of Customer Care, couldn't have been more corporate: "All complaints have been taken care of," he said.

against other code gladiators, not just from one city, but from across the nation. To be held on January 17, 2005 at K K Wagh College of Engineering, Nashik, it promises to be an all round test of programming skills.

Codeprix '05 will have six different challenges: 'KnowledgeTest' will test quick thinking and accuracy. 'Codathlon' will test how quickly the participants can code, and how compact, efficient and accurate their code is. 'Trashcode', the antithesis of 'Codathlon', will test the ability of the participants to write the worst code possible. The challenge of 'X-code' is to write a programme to

GENDER



BENDERS

Abhishek Kumar vs Vaishali Sanwane Find and Start the Windows Disk Defragmenter



Abhishek, a medical student smirked. "Mission Impossible? NO WAY!" A swift click on the Start button, and the next moment, the arrow key was looking up the Programs list. In a few more moments, he found his way out—Accessories > System Tools, and there you go, Disk Defragmenter. The hunt ended almost as soon as it had begun. A second's hesitation, a right-click on C:, and that's it. A cakewalk indeed!



As Vaishali, also a medical student, hesitated for a while before launching the hunt, the task suddenly looked stiffer. But that was not to be. She kept her cool, and steadily ran the mouse over the Programs list. Oops, where's the System Tools? Accessibility... Communication... Entertainment... Ah! Finally. Soon, the elusive Disk Defragmenter showed up. Not quite at lightning speed, but still a good job!